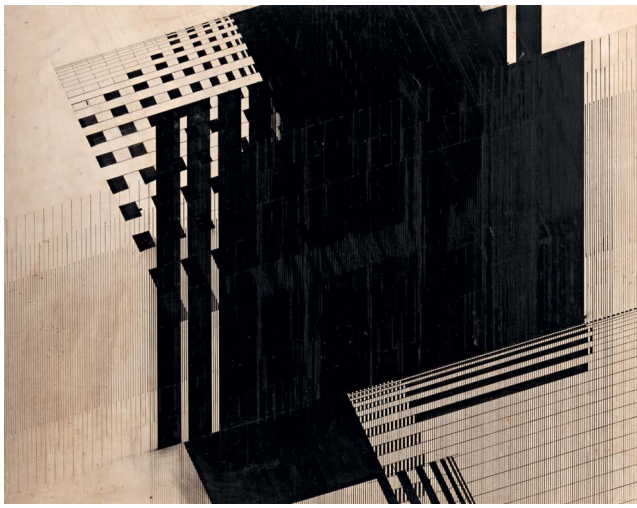
ART ▼

FINDING A COMMON RHYTHM

IN-RHYTHM AT KNMA, NEW DELHI, REVEALS A SHARED LANGUAGE OF ABSTRACTION AND GEOMETRY BETWEEN LATE ARTISTS BICE LAZZARI AND NASREEN MOHAMEDI





LINE BY LINE Mohamedi's 'Unknown' and (below) Lazzari's 'Architettura Azzurra'

The Kiran Nadar Museum of Art (KNMA) in New Delhi brings Italian artist Bice Lazzari (1900-1981) and Indian artist Nasreen Mohamedi (1937-1990) into dialogue through *In-Rhythm*, an exhibition exploring the affinities between two artists who never met and are not known to have encountered each other's work. The exhibition examines their shared engagement with line, geometry, repetition and restraint. Presented in partnership with the Italian Embassy Cultural Centre in New Delhi and Archivio Bice Lazzari in Rome, the exhibition is curated by Andrea Anastasio, director of the Italian Cultural Institute in New Delhi, and Roobina Karode, artistic director and chief curator at KNMA, assisted by curator Neha 'Zooni' Tickoo.

Lazzari and Mohamedi arrived at remarkably similar approaches to abstraction. Lazzari gradually moved towards lines, grids and subtle fields of colour, while Mohamedi became known for her precise geometric compositions. For both, repetition and restraint offered ways to explore rhythm and emotion. Anastasio and Karode describe





EXCAVATING A LEGACY The exhibition features sculptures in terracotta, wood, bronze, concrete and cement

ART ▼

THE UNSUNG MODERNIST

AN EXHIBITION IN KOLKATA SEEKS TO RECLAIM THE LEGACY OF THE LATE SCULPTOR **SUREN DE**

The *Figures of Resilience* exhibition at Kolkata's Art Exposure gallery brings to light the works of one of Indian modernist art's unsung heroes, Surendranath De, better known as Suren De. The Tripura-born artist has long been in the shadow of Santiniketan heavyweights such as Nandalal Bose and Ramkinkar Baij (both of whom taught him) and Mumbai's Progressive Artists' Group. De's sparse, elemental sculptures were historically sidelined. This exhibition intends to change that.

What is striking about the collection is De's deft control across materials—wood, terracotta, bronze and concrete—along with a fascination for folk imagery, like weavers, dancers and household tools.

"Suren De deserves to be understood within the larger history of post-Independence Indian modernism," says Art Exposure's director and founder, Somak Mitra. "From Santiniketan, he inherited an approach to sculpture that encouraged experimentation rather than adherence to a predetermined artistic idiom.